

Material Handling

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.176 (materials) · 1910.178 (powered industrial trucks) · General Duty Clause

DATE _____ FACILITATOR _____ DEPT / SHIFT _____ HEADCOUNT _____

WHY THIS MEETING

Most shop strains, crushed fingers, and struck-by injuries happen while moving product — sheet stock, totes, pallets, and finished goods. Plan the move, use a cart when you can, and keep paths clear.

TODAY'S TALKING POINTS

1. OSHA does not set one legal lifting weight. If the load is awkward, above the shoulders, or you cannot see the path — get help or a mechanical aid.
2. Know the weight and the route before you pick it up. Clear clutter, oil, and offcuts first (1910.176).
3. Stack so it cannot fall. Band or restack unstable loads. Never pull from the middle of a stack.
4. Use carts, pallet jacks, or hoists for sheet goods, stacked product, and anything you must carry more than a few steps.
5. Stay out of the line of fire: never stand under a raised load, walk under forks, or put hands between a load and a rack.
6. Forklifts and powered pallet jacks: trained and authorized operators only. Pedestrians stop, make eye contact, use walkways.

BEFORE YOU MOVE IT

- Can one person move this safely, or do you need a teammate, cart, or jack?
- Is the path clear to the destination — no cords, scrap, or wet floors?
- Is the stack or pallet stable? Fix it before it travels.
- Are exits, aisles, panels, and fire gear still open after you set it down?
- Long stock: one person on each end, call the corner, watch for others.
- Powered equipment: inspect it first. Do not operate damaged forks, brakes, or horns.

DO

- Bend at the knees and hips; keep the load close; turn with your feet.
- Team-lift bulky material and say who is walking backward.
- Secure loads on carts so they cannot slide or tip.
- Set brakes or chock wheeled equipment when loading.

DON'T

- Twist at the waist while lifting or throwing product onto a stack.
- Block aisles, exits, electrical panels, or extinguishers.
- Ride a pallet jack, stand on forks, or walk under a raised load.
- Leave materials leaning on machines or hanging off a rack edge.

ASK THE CREW

1. What do we move every day that should go on a cart instead of in our hands?
2. Where do stacks or aisle clutter create a struck-by or trip hazard on this floor?
3. What do we shout or signal when carrying long stock around a corner?

STOP WORK IF

The load is unstable, the path is blocked, the lift equipment is damaged, or you were not trained on that equipment. Stop and get help.

ATTENDANCE · PRINT NAME AND INITIAL

1. _____	2. _____
3. _____	4. _____
5. _____	6. _____
7. _____	8. _____